

FTF 2010: Freescale Clicks On Innovation

Freescale Semiconductor along with its partners and customers unleashed imagination and powered innovation at the Freescale Technology Forum (FTF)

A real-time imagination drive—that was the vision showcased by Freescale Semiconductor at the *Freescale Technology Forum (FTF)* held in Bengaluru recently. The event kicked off with live demonstration of the Acc-eleGlove, using which the demonstrator's hand and finger movement acted as commands controlling the virtual environment. Wearing the glove powered by Freescale's 3-D micro-electromechanical system (MEMS) accelerometers, the demonstrator tossed videos between screens, brought a rotating globe to halt and performed other hand-gesture communication acts that have been seen by most people only in special-effects cinematic wonders like *Matrix* or the most recent *Inception*. The pulse of *FTF 2010* revolved around unleashing imagination and powering innovation.

Era of connected intelligence

Freescale unfolded the new era of connected intelligence that would be dominated by devices expanding Internet connectivity like mobile computing, smartphones and smart mobile devices, including those found in automobiles. "This era has been an era of improved efficiency, services and entertainment. We have now entered an era of connected intelligence. Freescale, being a leader in communication processors (commanding 70 per cent of Internet connections), RF power, automotive microcontrollers, etc, is uniquely positioned for this era of connected intelligence," said Henri Richard, senior vice president, chief sales and marketing officer, Freescale Semiconductor.

Giving an insight on the automotive facet, Dr Reza Kazeroonian,

senior vice president and general manager, microcontroller solutions, Freescale Semiconductor, said, "In the automotive industry, there is a need to innovate faster. A few years from now, active safety systems like blind spot detection, adaptive cruise control and lane departure warning will be incorporated to the cars, traffic signal and infrastructure detection systems. We can also expect to see more car-to-car communication that will prevent accidents. Freescale's most advanced safety microcontroller—a dual-core power architecture MCU—has been designed at Noida Design Center for the same. Another intriguing area of automotive growth is infotainment and driver information systems, where we will soon see video cameras replacing mirrors and wireless broadband making automobile the ultimate mobile communications device."

Freescale family dons the innovation hat

The display of reference designs in the automotive, industrial, consumer, networking and enabling technologies segment by Freescale and its customers and partners showed the commitment to innovation and design.

Advancing consumer electronics. Today,

power efficiency has become a huge bottleneck in consumer electronics. Freescale and its partners have joined hands to resolve this issue. For instance, Future Electronics demonstrated a solar LED lantern, based on Freescale's MC9RS08KA4, with multiple features like dimming facility, low-battery indication, cell phone charging and FM radio. Alongside, AllGo Embedded Systems displayed a smart energy home network gateway built using Freescale's i.MX233 processor. It allows the user to manage his power usage and bills by turning on/off devices automatically during peak tariffs hours.

The fitness pulse was also high at FTF! Excelpoint Systems (India) displayed a Fitness4fun solution that tracks personal fitness on the go and an intelligent wireless digital pedometer with a wireless glove heart rate monitor (HRM) that collects fitness biometric data while exercising. "Our fitness monitoring product range is targeting weight management fitness companies," says Frank Fong, deputy director, solutions marketing, Excelpoint Systems. Arrow Electronics India displayed a next-generation musical instrument called the Stringless Guitar that uses Freescale MC9S08JM60 and MC9S08QG8 microcontrollers.

On the high-speed automotive lane. A car driver can now change FM stations or select his favourite play list, just by giving voice commands to the car entertainment system—thanks to Excelpoint Systems' (India) voice-assisted in-car control (VICK). Alongside, Avnet India has embedded intelligence in power windows of cars with its Anti-Pinch protection solution.

Revolutionising the health

